Using a Light Microscope

1. Always carry a microscope with two hands. Hold the microscope by the arm with one hand, and place your other hand underneath the stage to support it.
2. Turn the object lens to the lowest magnification (usually X4 or X10) until you hear it click.
3. Place the microscope slide you want to observe on the stage, and ensure it is secured with the stage clips.
4. Using the coarse adjustment knob, slowly lower the objective lens until it is close to the slide, but not touching it. Make this adjustment while viewing the microscope slide from the side and not through the eyepiece lens.
5. Look through the eyepiece lens and adjust the mirror and / or light to find the brightest level.
6. Slowly turn the coarse adjustment knob so that the objective lens goes up (away from the slide), whilst observing through the eyepiece lens for the image to come into focus.
7. Use the fine adjustment knob to view the image more clearly.



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Remember:

- DO NOT let the lens touch the slide – it could damage it.
- Only clean the lens with specially designed cloths.
- Look through the eyepiece lens with one eye.
- The image you see is flipped vertically and horizontally, so bear this in mind when moving the slide to a more central position on the stage.